

# Ernest SONG ♦ Director of Finance

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*Director of Finance with 15+ years leading financial reporting, month-end close, and budgeting & forecasting for multi-entity, multi-country operations across BE, FR and NL. I specialise in financial reporting (IFRS), multi-entity consolidation, disciplined budgeting & forecasting with variance analysis, and automation of the month-end close. I read the numbers and the organisation behind them, bring calm under pressure, and turn raw finance data into executive Power BI reporting — a steady record of turning finance into a lever for growth.*

## Education

### ESCP Business School

(#1 FT 2026)

2010 – 2011 | Paris, FR

Specialized Master's degree

*Auditing and Consulting*

### Université Paris Nanterre

2005 – 2010 | Paris, FR

Master's degree

*Management Science and Financial Control*

## Competencies

### Finance Reporting & Planning

- Financial reporting
- Budgeting & forecasting
- Variance analysis

### Financial Close & Accounting

- Month-end close leadership
- General Accounting GL AP AR
- Multi-entity consolidation

### Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- Cognos
- QlikSense
- Business Objects
- Hyperion

### ERP Systems

- SAP S/4HANA
- SAP HANA
- SAP BPC

### Financial Modeling

- Cash flow modeling
- P&L partnering
- Business plans

### Data & Analytics

- SQL
- VBA
- R

### Governance & Control

- Internal control
- Regulatory reporting
- SOX context

### Operations & Cash

- Cash flow management
- Credit analysis
- Treasury needs

### Change & Agile

- Change management
- Jira
- Confluence

### M&A / Corporate Dev

- Corporate development
- M&A integration
- Valuation

## Languages

**Native:** French, Khmer, Teochew

**Proficient:** English

**Basics:** Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin

## Interests

Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis

## Interpersonal

Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer

## Professional Experience

### Engie SEM

January 2026 – Present | Brussels, BE

#### Director of Finance — Financial Reporting, Close & Budgeting

- Direct financial reporting and controlling across French subsidiaries as the core Business Analyst bridging IT architecture and business operations.
- Own month-end close automation for commodity trading, deploying PowerQuery ETL workflows that ingest 1,500+ bookings per close with zero manual intervention.
- Deliver a budgeting & forecasting model built from scratch within a 2-week window, replacing an unreliable legacy framework to protect operational continuity.
- Reconcile middle-office (IVDB) data with SAP S/4HANA and simplify WDS project codes to strengthen portfolio monitoring and variance analysis.

## **Holcim**

January 2024 – December 2025 | Nivelles, BE

### **Finance & Data Lead — Financial Reporting, M&A Integration**

- Support post-M&A operational restructuring using market and financial data insights that drive productivity and consolidation.
- Manage the SAP HANA migration, restructuring data and guaranteeing system integrity across multi-entity consolidation reporting.
- Build rebate models (matrix and automated SAP) aligned to commercial strategy and liaise with auditors on rebate matters.
- Roll out QlikSense financial reporting to turn SAP data into actionable executive insights.

## **Engie Tractebel**

March 2023 – December 2023 | Brussels, BE

### **Cash Flow & Financial Modeling — Treasury Advisory**

- Design cash flow reporting and per-project cash exposure to inform treasury and financing decisions.
- Assess financing needs, perform counterpart credit analysis and impairment testing for the local entity.
- Build finance data models from SAP HANA and design Power BI reporting to accelerate decision-making.

## **Shurgard**

February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE

### **Investment & Corporate Development — M&A / Real Estate**

- Manage real estate projects including construction, redevelopment and acquisition of self-storage businesses.
- Maintain a project dashboard and initiate corporate-development initiatives that improve departmental policies.
- Design the data model and visualisation for the Investment department's Business Intelligence reporting.
- Collaborate on an AI-based pricing model to strengthen commercial margin oversight.

## **Magnetrap**

November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE

### **Freelance CFO / Fundraising Consultant — P&L & Treasury Advisory**

- Serve as interim CFO and lead fundraising, arranging €3M in debt and equity financing.
- Prepare cash flow projections, business plans and long-term financial goals under P&L oversight.
- Monitor performance metrics and implement corrective actions to protect profitability.
- Prepare operating-results reports and maintain financial models for ongoing strategic planning.

## **Tobania**

February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE

### **Director Business Process Automation — Finance Operations Partnering**

- Launch a citizen-developer model using RPA and self-service BI, defining pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Drive business development across marketing, pre-sales and sales to expand finance-operations offerings.
- Standardise and harmonise processes to improve efficiency and profitability for clients.
- Deliver cost-control reporting and establish change management structures to accelerate adoption.

## **Soap collect**

January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH

### **Founder — Non-Profit & Sustainability**

- Establish a non-profit providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Partner with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning and scale impact.

## **Vinci Airports**

February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT

### **Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling**

- Drive value creation with a valuation at 4 times acquisition cost across a concession portfolio.
- Deploy airport operations across 50+ locations in multiple countries while managing accounting.
- Build long-term financial business models incorporating macroeconomic impact, CapEx and concession valuation.
- Negotiate concession contract extensions and improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Manage financial reporting in line with BE-GAAP standards across operations.

## **Rexel**

September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR

### **Reporting Consolidation Manager — IFRS Financial Reporting**

- Lead IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America and Canadian subsidiaries.
- Integrate SAP BPC and Cognos reporting systems to strengthen consolidation.
- Perform annual budgeting, monthly forecasting and variance analysis versus budgeted results.
- Lead the strategic planning process for the organisation.

**Financial Auditor Supervisor — Governance & Compliance**

- *Audit financial statements under various accounting standards, including SOX process testing.*
- *Review financial modeling for long-term Public-Private Partnership contracts.*
- *Certify FP7 grant agreements and lead supervised audit teams.*
- *Develop partnerships and identify new markets to support business growth.*
- *Cover main sectors: construction, real estate, water distribution, parcels distribution, security and healthcare.*

**ICM - Brain & Spine Institute***November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR***Deputy CFO Trainee — Budgeting & Internal Control**

- *Implement the budget system and prepare business plans for scientific teams.*
- *Establish internal control for purchasing and donation processes and manage bank reconciliation.*
- *Prepare the institutional audit supporting certification by the “Comité de la Charte”.*